

MUSICATED RECORDS · IN HOUSE WE TRUST

# Your website.

## How to change anything.

No code knowledge needed. If you can edit a document and click Save, you can run this site.

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Written for Eric Martin · August 2026

Your whole website is **7 files** living in one place on GitHub. You open a file, change some words, click Save. About a minute later the real website updates by itself. That's the entire system.

### 1 The one link you need

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Everything lives here. Bookmark it:

`github.com/brucemacvaughn/musicated-records`

Your live website is at `brucemacvaughn.github.io/musicated-records` — and once the domain is switched over, at `musicatedrecords.com`. Both show the same thing.

### 2 How to change words on the site

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Say you want to fix a sentence on the About page.

- 1 Go to the GitHub link above.
- 2 Click the file you want. For the About page, that's `about.html`.
- 3 Click the **pencil icon** (top right of the file). You're now editing.

- 4 Use **Ctrl+F** (Windows) or **Cmd+F** (Mac) to find the sentence you want to change.
- 5 Change **only the words**. Leave everything with angle brackets like `<p>` alone.
- 6 Scroll down, click the green **Commit changes** button.
- 7 Wait about a minute. Refresh your website. Done.

### The one rule that matters

Words live *between* the angle-bracket tags. In `<p>Hello there</p>` you can safely change *Hello there* to anything you like. Don't touch the `<p>` or `</p>` parts — those tell the browser "this is a paragraph."

## 3 Which file is which page

| WHAT YOU SEE ON THE SITE                         | FILE TO EDIT                   |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Home page                                        | <code>index.html</code>        |
| Buy / Listen                                     | <code>listen.html</code>       |
| Live                                             | <code>live.html</code>         |
| Sync · TV / Film                                 | <code>sync.html</code>         |
| About                                            | <code>about.html</code>        |
| Contact                                          | <code>contact.html</code>      |
| Merch (hidden for now, still exists)             | <code>merch.html</code>        |
| Colours, fonts, spacing — the look of everything | <code>assets/styles.css</code> |
| Record covers                                    | <code>assets/releases/</code>  |
| TV show artwork on the Sync page                 | <code>assets/tv/</code>        |

### Menus and footers are copied into every page

If you add a link to the top menu, you have to make the same change in all 7 files, or the menu will look different depending on which page someone is on. This is the most common way the site gets messy.

## 4 How to swap a picture

The safest method — and the one that avoids the problem below — is to **keep the same file name**.

- 1 Name your new image exactly what the old one was called, e.g. `cover-believe.jpg`.
- 2 In GitHub, go into the folder (e.g. `assets/releases`).
- 3 Click **Add file** → **Upload files** and drop the new image in.
- 4 Click **Commit changes**. Because the name matched, it simply replaces the old one and every page using it updates at once.

### Sizes to aim for

- **Record covers:** 800 × 800 pixels, under 200 KB.
- **TV / sync artwork:** square, 800 × 800, under 200 KB.
- Never upload a photo straight off a phone or from a designer without shrinking it. A 5 MB image makes the page take forever to load on a phone — one had crept in and was slowing the site down.

## 5 The logo — read this one carefully

This is the thing that wasted a lot of time. The logo is **not** in one place. Changing it in one spot leaves the old one showing elsewhere, which makes it look like the website "didn't update."

The logo reaches the site through **three separate routes**:

| WHERE YOU SEE IT                                                                        | WHAT IT ACTUALLY COMES FROM                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Big logo on the spinning record, the panel on the home page, the panel on About         | <code>assets/musicated-logo-circle.png</code>          |
| Small square logo in the top-left menu bar, and the tiny icon on the browser tab        | The <code>favicon</code> files in <code>assets/</code> |
| The picture that appears when someone shares a link on WhatsApp, Instagram or in a text | <code>assets/og-card.jpg</code>                        |

### What to do when the logo changes

Upload the new logo as `musicated-logo-circle.png` — that fixes the first row on its own. The favicons and the share picture are *made from* the logo, not linked to it, so they have to be regenerated. Ask Mac (or Claude) to "regenerate the favicons and og-card from the new logo." It takes a minute. Without that step, the small logo in the menu bar stays old forever, no matter how many times you edit the pages.

## 6 "I changed it and nothing happened"

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Work down this list in order. It's nearly always the first two.

- 1 **Wait 10 minutes.** GitHub holds files for about ten minutes before serving the new version. This is normal and it fixes itself.
- 2 **Hard-refresh your browser.** `Cmd+Shift+R` on Mac, `Ctrl+Shift+R` on Windows. A normal refresh often shows you the old page from your own computer's memory.
- 3 **Check it actually saved.** On GitHub, open the file and look at the top — it shows when it was last changed. If your edit isn't there, you didn't hit Commit.
- 4 **Check the build ran.** Click the **Actions** tab on the repo. A green tick means the site rebuilt. A red X means something is broken — see the next section.
- 5 **Try your phone on mobile data.** If it looks right there but wrong on your laptop, it's your laptop's cache, not the website.

### Good news

There used to be a version number on every link ( `?v=20260829a` ) that had to be updated by hand every single time, or the site would serve old files. That's been removed. You no longer have to think about it — just wait the ten minutes.

## 7 If you break something

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Nothing you do is permanent. Every change is saved forever and can be undone in about thirty seconds.

- 1 Go to the repo and click **Commits** (the little clock icon with a number next to it).
- 2 Find the change that broke things — they're listed newest first, with your description.
- 3 Click it, then click the ... menu at the top right and choose **Revert**.
- 4 Confirm. The site goes back to how it was before that change.

Because of this, you cannot permanently ruin the site by experimenting. The worst case is it looks wrong for a few minutes.

## 8 Using ChatGPT (Codex) to make changes

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You're using **Codex**, the coding side of ChatGPT. It's connected straight to your repository, so it can read every file and commit changes for you without you clicking anything on GitHub. That's genuinely useful — but it changes what you need to watch for.

### What it can do

- Read any file in the site and change it.
- Commit the change itself. It appears under your name in the history.
- You don't need to paste files in. It already has them.

### What it cannot do — and this is the important part

- **It cannot see your actual website.** It reads the code, not the finished page in a browser. It has no idea what the site looks like.
- **It cannot make images.** Regenerating the favicons after a logo change, or resizing a photo, needs a person with an image tool. Ask Mac.
- **It cannot tell that a change had no effect.** It will edit a file, see the edit succeeded, and report success — even if the thing you were trying to fix comes from somewhere else entirely.

### The exact mistake that already happened

You asked it to change the logo. It changed the logo in `index.html`, correctly, and reported success. The old logo kept showing — because it was also coming from the favicon files and the share picture, which it never touched and cannot make. It then concluded the website "wasn't serving the right files" and suggested digging into deployment settings. The website was fine the whole time.

A confident explanation from an AI that cannot see your site is a guess.

## Two habits that prevent all of this

- 1 **Always look at the real site yourself** after it says it's done. Wait ten minutes, hard-refresh, and check with your own eyes. Its "done" means "I edited a file," not "it works."
- 2 **If a suggestion sounds drastic, stop and ask Mac.** Changing deployment settings, deleting files, renaming things, switching branches — none of that is ever the fix for "my change didn't show up." The fix is nearly always waiting ten minutes.

### Worth knowing: three AI tools can edit this site

Codex, Claude and Cursor all have permission to commit to your repository. Everything they do is recorded under your name and can be undone (see section 7), so nothing is unrecoverable — but if a change appears that you didn't ask for, that's where it came from. You can review or remove them any time under

**Settings** → **GitHub Apps**

on the repo.

## 9 Things to leave alone

- `assets/hero-viz.js` — draws the spinning record. Fiddly. Ask first.
- `.nojekyll` — an empty file that must stay, or images stop loading.
- File and folder **names**. Renaming a page breaks every link to it and any bookmark anyone has.
- Anything inside `< >` brackets, unless you know what it does.

## 10 Quick wins you can do today

- **Add a new record** to the home page: copy an existing block in `index.html` that starts with `<a class="release"`, paste it below, and change the picture name, artist and title.
- **Change an email address**: search for `@musicatedrecords.com` and edit.
- **Change the newsletter heading**: search for `Stay Up to`.
- **Bring the Merch page back**: the page still exists, it's just hidden from the menu. Ask for it to be re-linked when the store is ready.